

CHINESE REVOLUTION



THE CHINESE REVOLUTION refers to the bitter struggle for control of China between the Kuomintang, or Nationalists, led by Chiang Kai-shek, and the Communists, led by Mao Zedong. The struggle

began in the 1920s, when the Nationalists expelled the Communists from their movement; it ended in 1949, when the Communist Party took power, and Chairman Mao proclaimed that China was a People's Republic. Under Mao's leadership, China was transformed from a backward peasant society into one of the most powerful nations in the world.

Long March

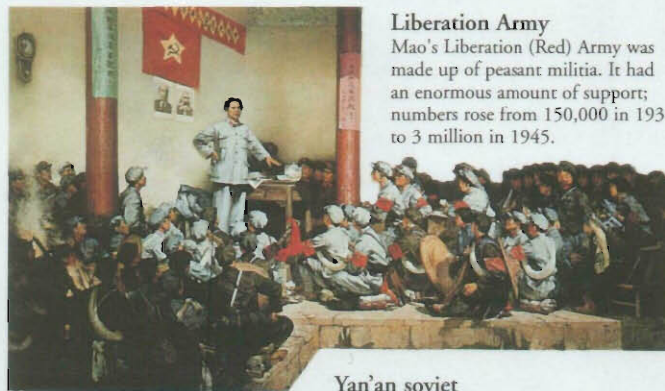
In 1931 Mao and a small band of Communists set up China's first communist state in Jiangxi, southern China. The Kuomintang attacked them constantly, and in 1934 Mao was forced to withdraw. The following year he led 100,000 people, mostly peasants, over 9,000 km (6,000 miles) of some of the world's roughest terrain, to a new base in Shaanxi province in the north. The Long March crossed 18 mountain ranges, 24 rivers, and passed through 11 provinces and 62 cities.

Only 30,000 marchers out of the original 100,000 reached their destination.



Mao Zedong

The son of a peasant, Mao (1893–1976) followed the nationalist ideals of Sun Yat-sen. In 1921, he helped found the Chinese Communist Party. Convinced that revolution should come from the peasants, not the industrial workers, he built a huge following. After victory against Chiang Kai-shek, he became chairman of the new republic.



Mao Zedong addressing followers at the Yan'an soviet during the early days of the revolution.

Yan'an soviet

In 1935, Mao set up new headquarters in northern China – his Yan'an soviet, or base. He and his followers lived in caves around the city of Yan'an, and went into the countryside where they recruited a huge following among the peasantry.



Little Red Book

Cultural Revolution

In 1966, in an attempt to introduce revolutionary zeal, Mao introduced a socialist cultural revolution to attack the four "olds": old ideas, old culture, old customs, and old habits. Those accused of "revisionism" (rejecting the revolution) were publicly humiliated in "struggle meetings". The Cultural Revolution ended in 1969, but its excesses nearly led to civil war.



Red Guard

Radical students, trained as Red Guards, were the main participants in the Cultural Revolution. Using the *Little Red Book*, containing the thoughts of Chairman Mao, the Red Guard attacked anyone they believed guilty of betraying the revolution.

Timeline

1911 Nationalist revolution ends rule of the Manchu dynasty. A republic is formed.

1921 Chinese Communist Party formed.

1926 Northern Expedition: Communists and Nationalists unite to fight warlords.

1927 Kuomintang under Chiang Kai-shek attacks and executes hundreds of Communists.

Chairman Mao



1931 Japan invades Manchuria.

1934–35 Long March. Communists march to Shaanxi.

1937–45 Japan invades China. Communist guerrillas harass Japanese and liberate most of northern China by 1945.

1945–48 Civil war between Kuomintang and Communists after Japanese surrender in World War II. Mao's

Communists gain control, and set up government in Beijing (Peking). Nationalists and Chiang Kai-shek flee to Taiwan.

1 October 1949 People's Republic of China is declared.



1911 Revolution

In 1911, a Nationalist revolution overthrew the Manchu dynasty, and created a republic in southern China. Sun Yat-sen (1866–1925) was elected provisional president of the republic, but the lives of the peasants did not improve, and real power remained with warlords (military leaders).

Kuomintang

In 1926, a Kuomintang general named Chiang Kai-shek (1887–1975) defeated the warlords, helped by the Communist Party. Chiang set up a government in Nanking but, once in power, he threw the Communists out of the government and massacred many Communist leaders.



Green wool trousers

Red Army uniform

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